

**Brookline Conservation Commission Meeting
Tuesday, March 27, 2012, 7 p.m.
Town Hall, School Committee Room**

Commissioners Present: Kate Bowditch (Chair), Werner Lohe, Randolph Meiklejohn, Roberta Schnoor, Marcus Quigley, Matthew Garvey, Pamela Harvey

Commissioners Absent: Gail Fenton, Marian Lazar

Staff Present: Tom Brady, Heather Charles Lis

Guests Present: n/a

AGENDA REVIEW/MINUTES

W. Lohe moved to approve the minutes from 2/28/12. M. Quigley seconded. All in favor.

FISHER HILL RESERVOIR PARK UPDATE & DISCUSSION

T. Brady gave an update on the Fisher Hill project, including a site visit he attended with staff and consultants, which included reviewing existing trees and vegetation, location of proposed woodland paths, and proposed plantings. H. Lis gave a brief update on the plantings, habitat and stormwater discussions from the last committee meeting. G. Fenton will provide a more detailed update at the next meeting.

REVIEW SPRING TOWN MEETING WARRANT TO DETERMINE WHICH, IF ANY, ARTICLES THE COMMISSION WILL DISCUSS AT A FUTURE MEETING

Commissioners briefly reviewed the Town Meeting Warrant. T. Brady clarified that Article 15, regarding the floodplain overlay district, does not include changes to the floodplain boundaries in Brookline, and contains mainly reference changes to keep the by-law consistent with new FEMA maps. Commissioners agreed to review the warrant themselves prior to the next meeting, and going forward they will discuss articles as early as feasible in the Town Meeting process.

OPEN SPACE PLAN REVIEW & DISCUSSION

K. Bowditch led a discussion of the Open Space Plan Action Plan. Commissioners agreed that current priorities include the categories of unprotected open space, green corridors, and watersheds and infrastructure. Commissioners discussed which categories and/or specific action items they are interested in working on. K. Bowditch provided an update on her recent meeting with Peter Ditto, Director of Engineering and Transportation, to discuss pilot green street projects and stormwater financing options. T. Brady discussed the steps and people needed to move forward on unprotected open space. K. Bowditch discussed the need to identify green corridors and their functions and values first. K. Bowditch suggested that subcommittees may work well to move forward on action items and suggested times when they could meet.

STAFF UPDATE

- G. Fenton is resigning from the Friends of Hall's Pond Board after many years of service.
- The Muddy River Maintenance and Management Oversight Committee's annual public meeting was held last week and was a positive meeting with a high number of attendees.
- Putterham Gold Course dredging activity and stream work is complete. There may be a future filing for removal of chlordane. T. Brady suggested a Commission site visit in the

future.

- The Brookline Conservation Land Trust has been meeting regularly and has requested to post information on their properties that are open to the public on the parks website. W. Lohe discussed efforts they have made at these properties. Several visitors have inquired about the properties, particularly since the new signage was installed.
- Commissioners agreed to hold the annual potluck on 4/26.
- T. Brady noted a high number of ticks in the area, particularly on a recent site visit to Singletree Reservoir.
- The annual goose egg addling permit has been received from the state and the town will do the addling soon at the Muddy River, as well as Hall's Pond and Larz Anderson if there are any nests there, which is less common. The border collies will also be starting soon with
- Brookline GreenSpace Alliance will have their annual meeting on 4/6 at Wheelock College.
- MACC is now offering the Fundamentals courses in a webinar format for Commissioners.
- CSX Transportation informed the town that they have submitted their Yearly Operational Plan for right-of-way vegetation management for the commuter railroad tracks in Brookline.
- The FY2013 budget is available and T. Brady briefly discussed relevant portions of the budget, including the forestry budget.

R. Meiklejohn moved to adjourn. R. Schnoor seconded. All in favor.

Documents Used at the Meeting:

- Meeting agenda
- Draft minutes from 2/28/12
- Spring Town Meeting Warrant & Explanations
- Organizational chart for Open Space Plan Five-Year Action Plan, updated by T. Brady & H. Lis, 3/27/12

Submitted by H. Lis.